

Neighbourhood Ethnographer

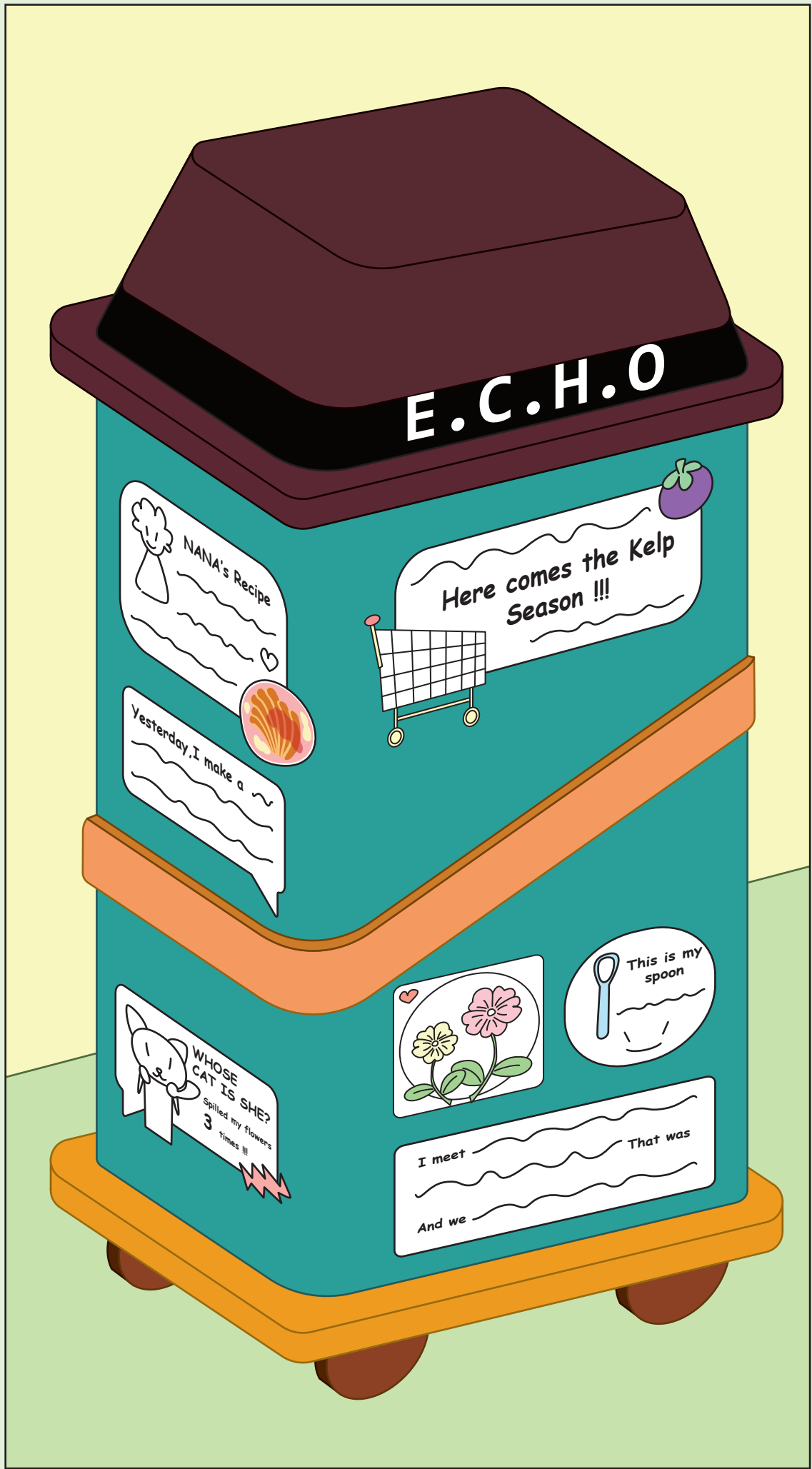
Background

As urban lifestyles evolve and technology advances, there is a rising interest in autonomous robots designed to enhance community life by performing daily tasks and fostering social connections among residents.

Through this project, we aim to create a **human-robot collaboration** to **record neighborhood history**, aiming to increase civic awareness, foster community engagement, and promote sustainable, resilient urban environments.

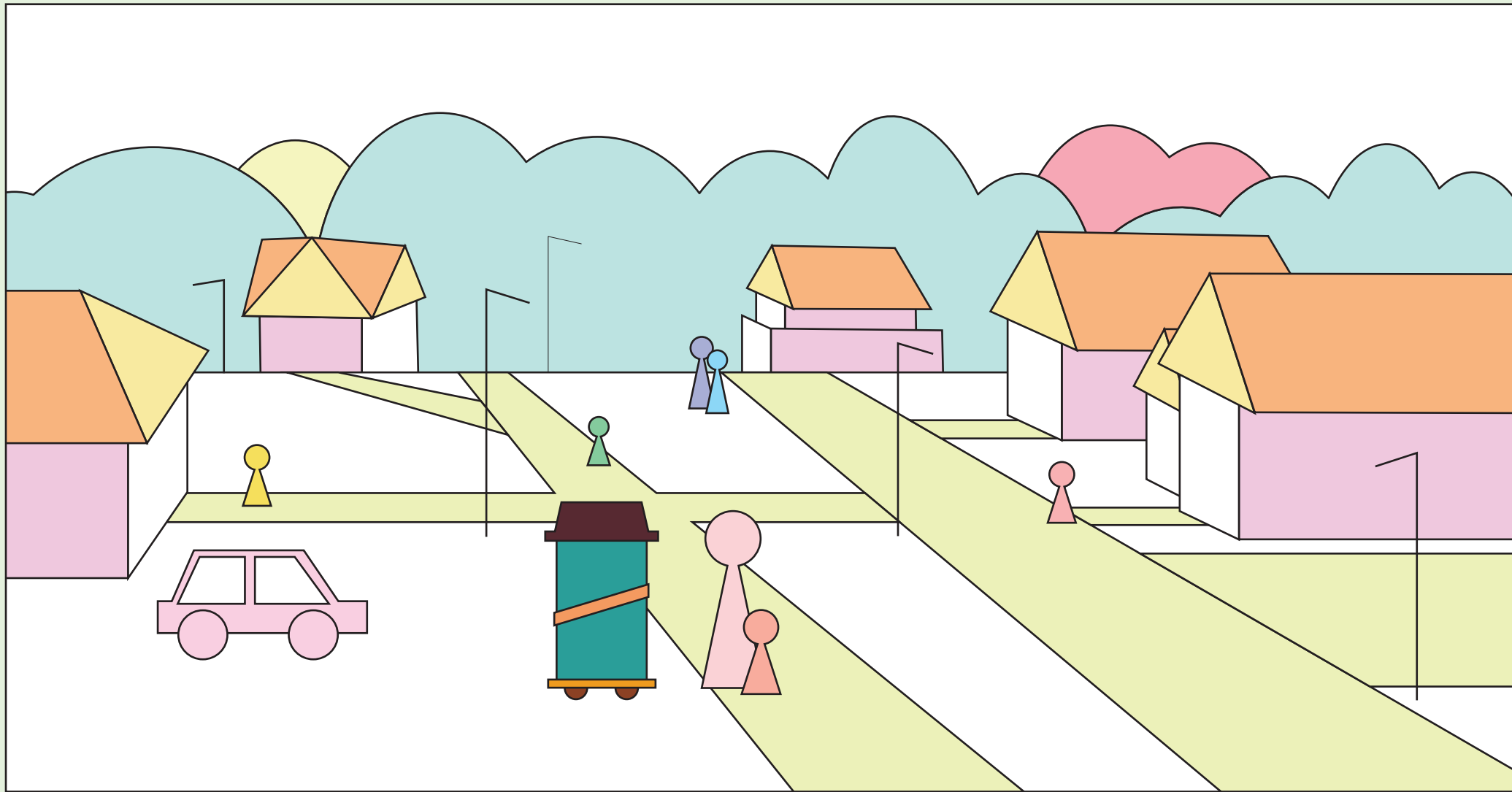
E.C.H.O Ethnographic Collection and Heritage Organizer

E.C.H.O. is a robot in the community that interacts with residents, collects their stories, and records them. The significance of this robot lies in its role of fostering communication and understanding within the community by documenting and sharing residents' stories, while also preserving and passing on the history and culture of the neighborhood.



Storyboard

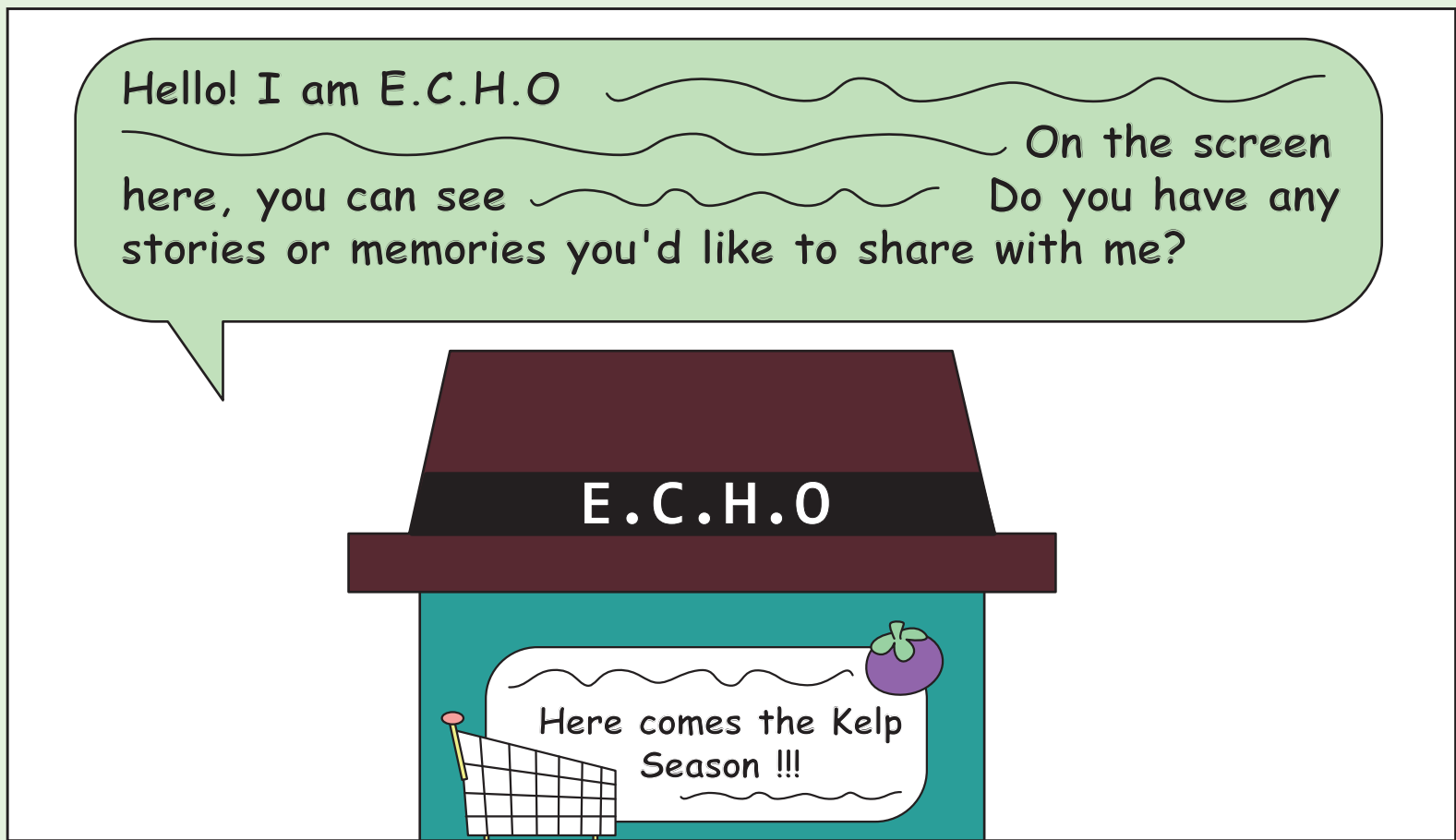
This is a storyboard introducing interactions between people and E.C.H.O. in the community. E.C.H.O_Ethnographic Collection and Heritage Organizer



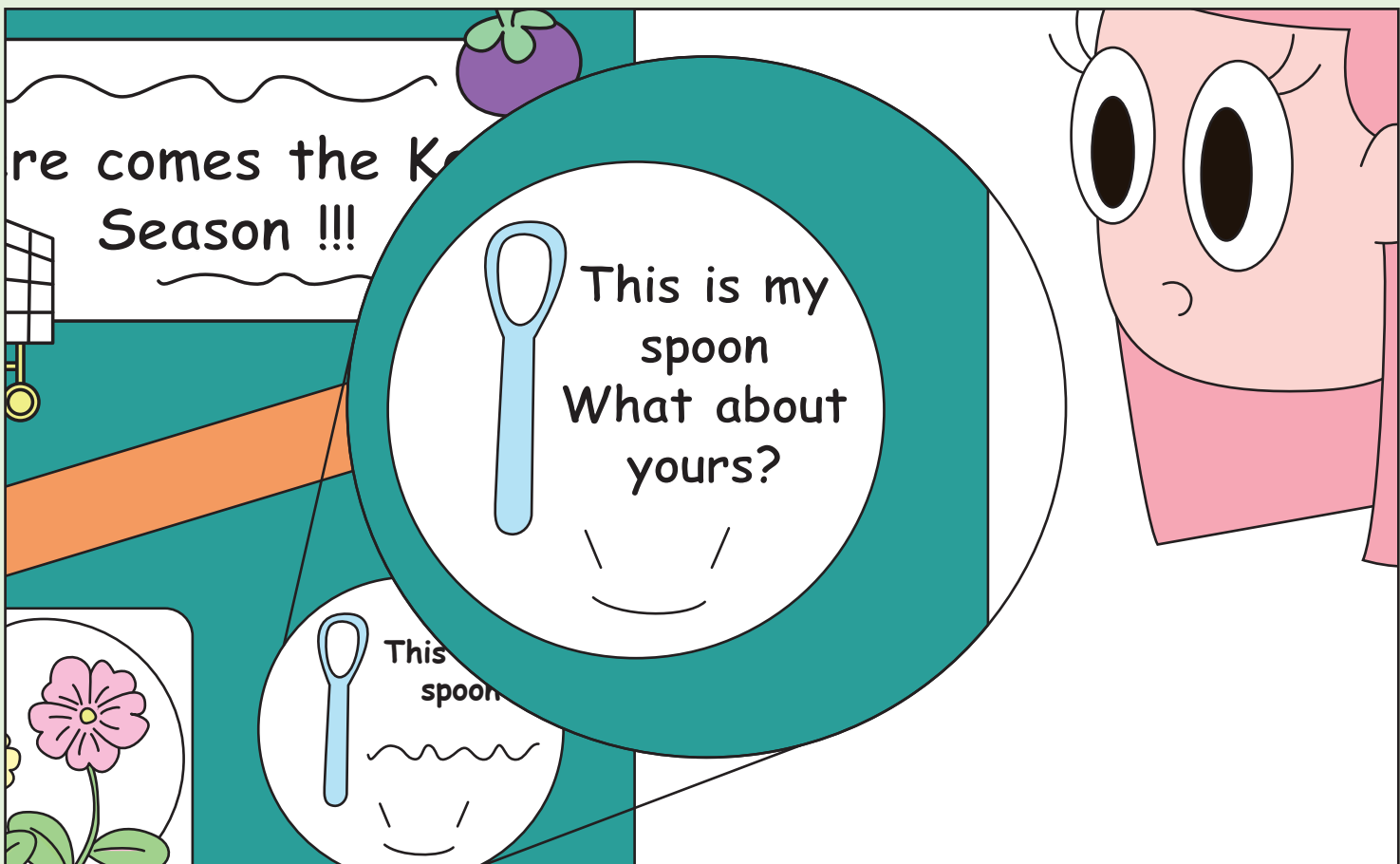
E.C.H.O. roams the community, conversing with residents, collecting their stories, and recording them.



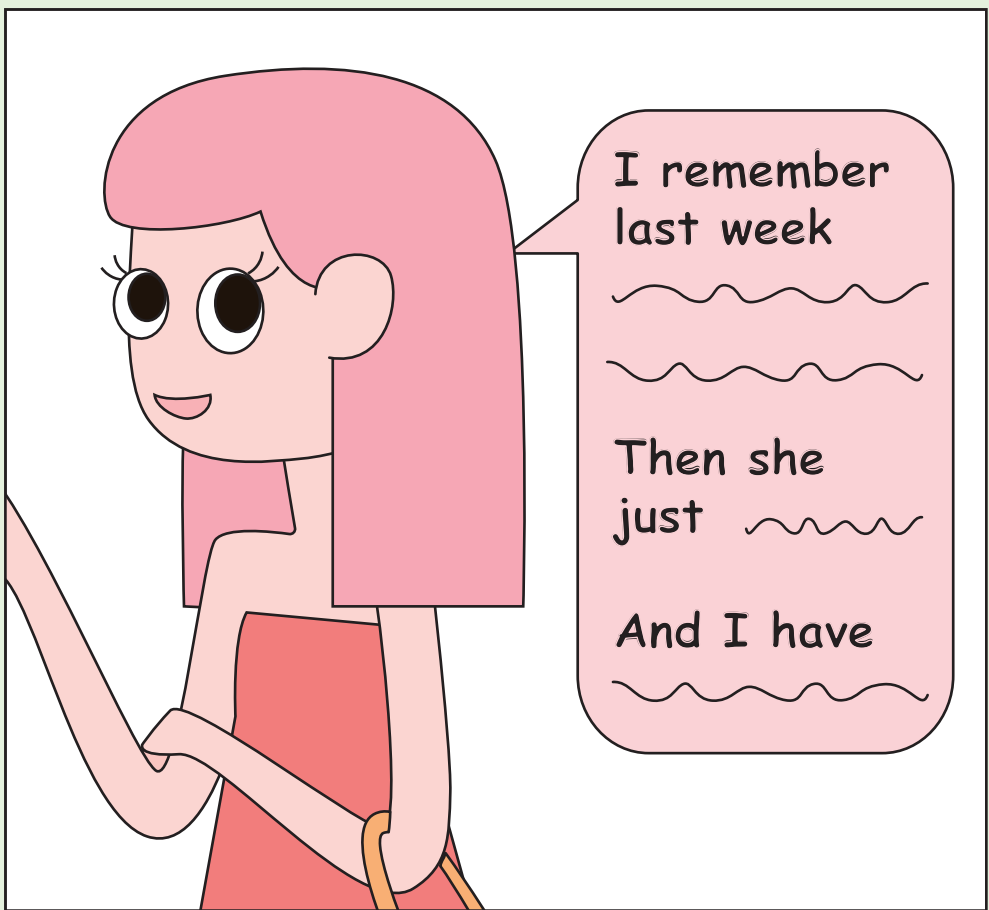
Sofie came home from work and saw E.C.H.O. She came over to say hello.



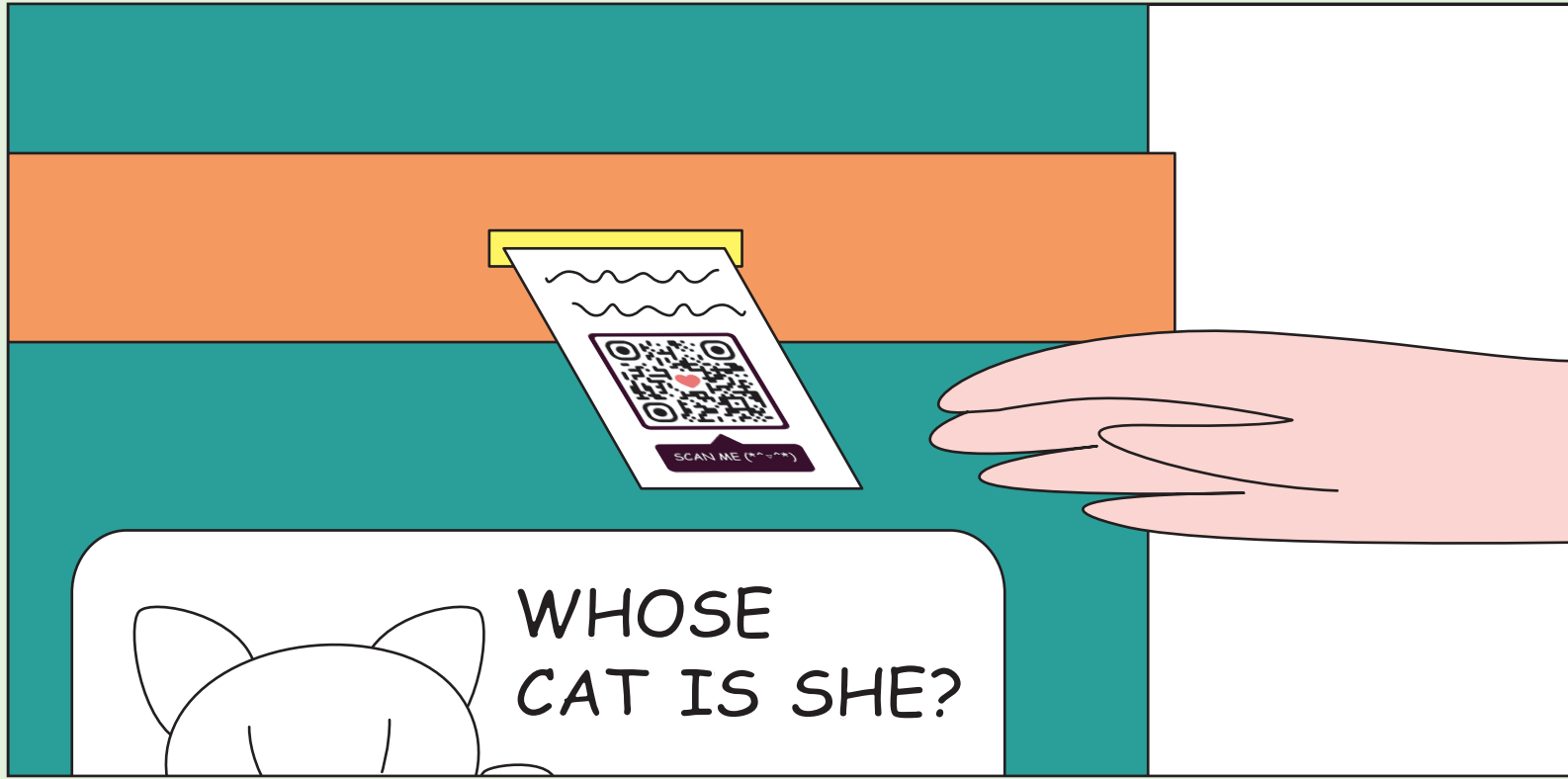
E.C.H.O. greets Sofie and introduces itself as a Neighborhood Ethnographer, here to gather stories and histories from the community. After briefly explaining the project, E.C.H.O. invites Sofie to view stories left by others on the large screen it carries. Finally, E.C.H.O. asks Sofie if she has any stories she would like to share.



On the body of the robot, Sofie see the new stories that already contributed to the archive.



After reading some of the stories. Sofie finds it very interesting and shares a recent amusing incident that happened in the neighborhood.



"Thank you for sharing your story, Sofie! Here is a token of appreciation just for you. You can scan the QR code on it to view your story, along with others that have been up-loaded in the community news."



After arriving home, Sofie scanned the QR code with her phone.



Since then, Sophie has regularly shared her stories with E.C.H.O. and visits a nearby storytelling centre. She even bought a small model of E.C.H.O. to keep on her desk. This made her feel more connected to the community and deepened her connection to her neighbourhood.